

Impact High · Difficulty Hard · Misuse risk Over-cushioning: protecting face so hard that the actual disagreement disappears.

THE MOVE

Face bridge + specific difference + shared criterion + dignified next step. -> I can see why speed is the priority. I see the launch date differently because the support load is still unresolved. Could we separate the launch decision from the demo ?

START HERE

One truthful bridge, then one precise point: "I can see why that read makes sense. I see one part differently: the timing, not the demand."

SAY THIS

Everyday / relational	"I get why that would be your read. I see one part differently."
Work / meetings	"I agree with the objective. I differ on the risk assessment."
Digital / written	"I see the rationale. I would push back on one part: the timeline assumes approvals we do not have yet."
Under pressure	"I know we need to move quickly. I still need to challenge this assumption."
Disagreeing upward	"Could I offer a different read without derailing the decision?"
Disagreeing downward	"I like that you are thinking ahead. I do not think this version is the right call yet."

AVOID

- There is immediate danger or a required safety escalation.
- The other person is acting in bad faith and using your politeness as a shield.
- A clear policy, legal, medical, safeguarding or compliance line has to be stated plainly.

REMEMBER

Save the person before you challenge the point.